BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #17 · AGING AND DECLINE

"My best years are behind me."

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Where it often comes from

Nostalgia is natural, but it can harden into believing that the good is over. Losses of health, spouse, or work make the past glow and the future dim.

What Scripture teaches

Solomon cautions that it is unwise to ask why the old days were better than these (Ecclesiastes 7:10), and says God "has made everything beautiful in its time" (Ecclesiastes 3:11). Paul, near the end of life, wrote, "Forgetting what is behind and straining toward what is ahead, I press on toward the goal." Jeremiah's lament says of the LORD's mercies, "They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!" Gratitude for the past and anticipation for what God still has can live together.

> *"Brothers, I do not consider myself yet to have taken hold of it. But one thing I do: Forgetting what is behind and straining toward what is ahead"* (Philippians 3:13).

Also see

> "He has made everything beautiful in its time. He has also set eternity in the hearts of men, yet they cannot fathom the work that God has done from beginning to end" (Ecclesiastes 3:11).

> "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!" (Lamentations 3:22–23).

> "Behold, I am about to do something new; even now it is coming. Do you not see it? Indeed, I will make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert" (Isaiah 43:19).

> "So teach us to number our days, that we may present a heart of wisdom" (Psalm 90:12).

Common self-statements

- The good times are gone.
- Nothing will compare.
- I peaked long ago.
- The future has nothing for me.
- Everything was better then.
- I just wait for the end.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing the past was all good and the present is all bad.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that nothing good lies ahead.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling nostalgic and concluding the best is gone.
- Labeling: Calling myself past my prime.

Challenging questions

- What made those years so good, and can any of it be found now?
- What good things am I experiencing today?

- What new thing could I try?
- What does God say about new mercies?
- What do I look forward to?
- Whom might I bless with my experience?

Truth summary

> I can thank God for the past and still look for His goodness today. God makes things beautiful in their time, and His mercies are new each morning.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Elderly
- Thankful
- Joy
- Hopeless
- Dissatisfaction

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Thinking, Healthy
- Suffering

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Already There — Casting Crowns
God's perspective extends beyond what we can currently understand.

Thrive — Casting Crowns
Life rooted in God includes purposeful growth and joy, not merely surviving or staying busy.

Forever — Kari Jobe
Christ's resurrection grounds hope in His victory over sin and death.

How Great Thou Art — Jordan Smith
This classic hymn connects God's greatness, Christ's sacrifice, and future hope.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "My best years are behind me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"My best years are behind me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What made those years so good, and can any of it be found now?
- ☐ What good things am I experiencing today?
- ☐ What new thing could I try?
- ☐ What does God say about new mercies?
- ☐ What do I look forward to?
- ☐ Whom might I bless with my experience?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God made everything beautiful in its time.
- ☐ His mercies are new every morning.
- ☐ I press on toward what is ahead.
- ☐ God does new things.
- ☐ Gratitude honors the past.
- ☐ Today holds gifts.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Philippians 3:13**
  "Brothers, I do not consider myself yet to have taken hold of it. But one thing I do: Forgetting what is behind and straining toward what is ahead."
- ☐ **Ecclesiastes 3:11**
  "He has made everything beautiful in its time. He has also set eternity in the hearts of men, yet they cannot fathom the work that God has done from beginning to end."
- ☐ **Lamentations 3:22–23**
  "Because of the loving devotion of the LORD we are not consumed, for His mercies never fail. They are new every morning; great is Your faithfulness!"

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] New mercies: Each day, name one good thing about today.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Philippians 3:13 becomes: "Sarah can write: "His mercies are new every morning.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Elderly" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Gratitude list. Write the blessings of the past with thanks.
- [ ] Try something new. Take a class, visit a place, or meet someone.
- [ ] Tell your stories. Share them with a grandchild or friend.
- [ ] Read Lamentations 3:22–23. Receive today's mercy.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "My best years are behind me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	New mercies
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~My best years are behind me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I treasure the past, but let me not miss today. Open my eyes to the good You are doing now and give me hope for what lies ahead. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.